

6.1 NATURE OF COURSEWORK

Coursework should provide candidates with an opportunity to address all three assessment objectives in order to demonstrate knowledge and understanding, appropriate skills and an ability to evaluate.

The coursework submitted as Parts A and B should reflect the best of the candidate's work in performing, composing and appraising during the whole course and must include coverage of at least **two** Areas of Study (*Exploiting the Resource* and **either** *Dance Music* **or** *Traditions and Innovation*). Candidates will also be able to demonstrate their understanding of techniques defined in Area of Study 2 (*Techniques of Melodic Composition*) in their composition work.

Coursework directly related to an Area of Study gives candidates the opportunity to show understanding in depth.

When setting coursework assignments, teachers should bear in mind the marking criteria set out in section 7.4 and should ensure that the tasks set will enable candidates of all abilities to gain access to the appropriate levels of marks. This will involve setting a range of differentiated tasks for a group of candidates and advising candidates on the suitability of their work. The requirements of the Areas of Study should also be considered.

Coursework must form an integral part of the teaching strategy for the specification. It is expected that the three elements - listening and appraising, performing and composing are taught not as separate elements but in an integrated way. Similarly, the Areas of Study must be central to the course. Coursework tasks in composing should be clearly defined, so that the candidate has a clear perception of what is expected and that it is possible to complete them in the time available. Appraising should become an integrated part of both performing and composing. It should be remembered that Coursework represents 60% of the Scheme of Assessment.

Candidates should be encouraged to use ICT and to appraise its use whenever appropriate.